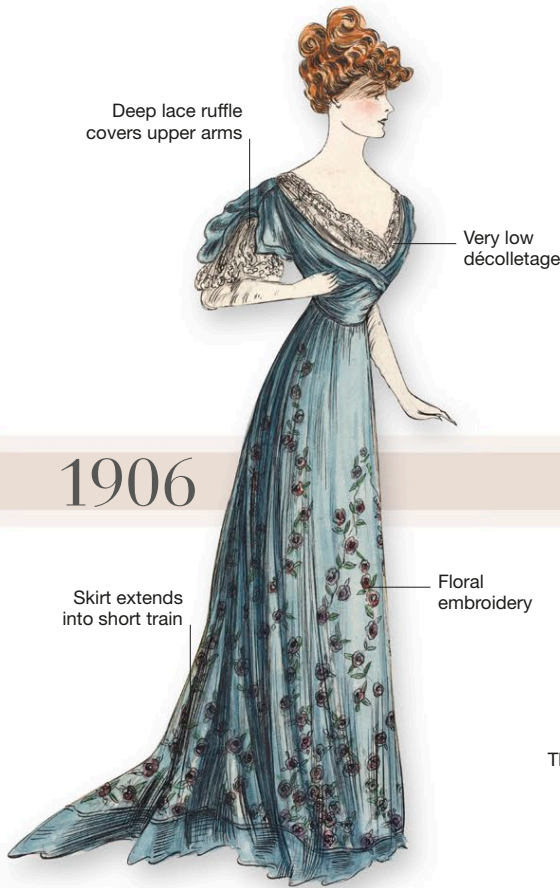




1906

Slimmer lines Towards the end of the first decade dresses become higher waisted and slimmer, as in this design for a French House of Paquin evening gown. Embroidery or lace trimmings were essential.



1907

Tea gown Worn indoors for afternoon tea, these gowns were usually made in light colours and soft fabrics, as seen in this magnificent example by the French House of Doucet. These garments went out of fashion around 1918.



Pink damask The loop attached to the train is slipped over the wrist to lift the gown during dancing. The lace echoes the floral pattern of the damask. A local English dressmaker may have made this dress.



1913

Dinner gown The longer sleeves and absence of embroidery and other surface decoration, apart from the fabric's pattern, mark this as a dinner, rather than an evening, gown. The skirt is split to aid movement. The new shape is very evident here.



1914

Robe du soir The French magazine *Gazette du Bon Ton* presents an idealized version of a Paquin evening gown. It shows the hallmarks of the new style: high waist, slimline but relatively loose, split skirt, and short "lampshade" overskirt.

FASHION AND THEATRE



London couturier Lady Duff-Gordon dressed actresses – such as musical comedy star Gertie Millar (above) – both on and off the stage. Duff-Gordon, who owned the House of Lucile in London, favoured slit skirts and low necklines. She used copies of dresses worn on stage to open a Paris branch of her House of Lucile Ltd in 1910.